

Research Interests

Political regimes, political socialization and education, migration, political attitudes and democratic support

Education

- 2019-2024 **PhD in Political and Social Sciences**
European University Institute, Florence
[The 2024 Linz Rokkan Prize for the best EUI doctoral thesis in Political Sociology](#)
Thesis: "The effects of political regimes on school quality and learning outcomes"
Examining Board: Prof. Juho Härkönen (European University Institute, supervisor), Prof. Filip Kostelka (European University Institute, co-supervisor), Prof. Sirianne Dahlum (University of Oslo), Prof. Katerina Tertychnaya (University of Oxford)
- 2019-2020 **MRes in Political and Social Sciences**
European University Institute, Florence
- 2018-2019 **MSc in Russian Politics and Society**
King's College London
- 2012-2016 **BA in International Relations, Political Science, and Human Rights**
Bard College, USA, and Saint Petersburg State University, Russia. *Dual degree.*

Current Positions

- 09/2023 – **Postdoctoral Researcher**
present *ERC-funded project MoveMeRU, PI: Dr. Félix Krawatzek*
- 06/2024 – **Senior Fellow**
present Free University of Berlin, Germany
Cluster of Excellence „Contestations of the Liberal Script” (SCRIPTS)

Publications

- Kostelka F., Alberdi M., Bradley M., Fiselier T., Jabbour A., Mansour N., Minaeva E., Porciuleanu S., **Rafailova D.** 2026. 'Mass Attitudes towards Russia's Aggression against Ukraine: Tentative Support for Top-Down Opinion Formation'. *European Journal of Political Research*.
- **Rafailova D.** 2026. [Title redacted for peer review]. Invited to Revise & Resubmit at *Political Studies*.
- **Rafailova D.** 2026. [Title redacted for peer review]. Under evaluation at *Post-Soviet Affairs*.
- Krawatzek F., Matevosyan H., **Rafailova D.** 2026. [Title redacted for peer review]. Invited to Revise & Resubmit at *European Political Science Review*.
- Nalla M.K., Gurinskaya A., and **Rafailova D.** 2017. 'Youth Perceptions of Private Security Guard Industry in Russia', *Journal of Applied Security Research*, 12:4, pp. 543-556.

Work-in-progress

- **Rafailova D.** 'Democracy, Educational Attainment, and Adult Skills'. *Draft available upon request*.
- **Rafailova D.** 'Interpreting Authoritarian Popularity: The Case of Russian Immigrant Families in Germany, Estonia, and Canada.' *Draft available upon request*.

Dissertation

- **Rafailova D.** 2024. *The effects of political regimes on school quality and learning outcomes* (Doctoral dissertation, European University Institute). DOI: 10.2870/758185.

Conferences

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| - The Italian Political Science Association (SISP) Conference | Sept 2026 |
| - European Political Science Society (EPSS) Annual Conference | 2026 |
| - American Political Science Association (APSA) Annual Meeting | 2025 |
| - The Future of Democracy? 1st Annual Interdisciplinary WZB Conference, Berlin | 2025 |
| - All Roads Lead to the Family? Political Socialisation Among Migrants and Non-Migrants, ZOIS (organizer and presenter) | 2025 |
| - Aleksanteri Conference "Resisting Authoritarianism in Eurasia" | 2024 |
| - Association for Slavic, East European, and Eurasian Studies (ASEEES) Annual Convention | 2024, 2025 |
| - European Political Science Association (EPSA) Annual Conference | 2022, 2024 |
| - Population Association of America (PAA) Annual Meeting | 2022 |

Invited Talks

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| - Politics of Russia and Eurasia Seminar Series (PRESS), <i>online workshop</i> | Dec 2025 |
| - Seminar Series in Social and Political Science, <i>Collegio Carlo Alberto, Turin, Italy</i> | Dec 2024 |
| - Humboldt-ZOIS colloquium on Eastern European research, <i>Berlin, Germany</i> | July 2024 |

Public Outreach and Engagement

- **Panelist**, "Political Representation in Exile: The Legitimacy and Influence of Democratic Forces Abroad," The Yuri M. Schmidt International Human Rights Conference, Berlin (forthcoming) 2026
- **Panelist**, "Practicing Democracy Under Pressure: Gagarin Center Alumni in Civil Society, Journalism, and Human Rights," Humboldt–Gagarin Conference on Contemporary Threats to Academic Freedom and Democracy, Berlin 2026
- **Publication**, "[What is driving Europe's pro-Russian supporters and their stance on the Russo-Ukrainian conflict?](#)", *The Conversation*, based on joint research by Kostelka et al. 2026

Teaching

- Dec 2025 **Guest Contribution to the Course by Prof. Gwendolyn Sasse**
Humboldt University, Berlin
- Oct 2024 **Workshop on Effective Research Design**
Centre for East European and International Studies (ZOiS), Berlin
- Feb 2022 **Teacher Training Certificate**
European University Institute, Florence

Other Research and Administrative Experience

- 09/2022 – **Research and Administrative Assistance to Prof. Elias Dinas**
- 07/2023 *European University Institute, Department of Political and Social Sciences*
- 11/2020 – **Academic Service Assistant**
- 01/2022 *European University Institute, Department of Political and Social Sciences*
- 09/2017 – **Junior Researcher**
- 08/2019 *European University at Saint Petersburg, Russia*

Grants and Awards

The 2024 Linz Rokkan Prize for the best EUI doctoral thesis in Political Sociology, EUI
EUI Wider European Doctorate grant, four-year stipend for conducting a PhD at the European University Institute (2019-2023), European University at Saint Petersburg
RC28 Conference Travel Award, London School of Economics and Political Science, 2022

Methodological Training

Field experiments, EUI SPS, 2021
List experiments, survey experiments and conjoint, EUI SPS, 2021
Advanced STATA coding, EUI SPS, 2021
Data Management in STATA, EUI SPS, 2019
Practicum in Reproducible Research Methods, EUI SPS 2020

Panel data, EUI SPS, 2020
Quantitative Methods, EUI SPS, 2019
Qualitative Methods, EUI SPS, 2020

Tools and Software

Stata (advanced), R (basic), MAXQDA (advanced), LaTeX (advanced)

Languages

English (fluent), Russian (native), Italian (A2), German (A1)